

Importance of involving users

- Expectation management
 - Realistic expectations
 - No surprises, no disappointments
 - Timely training
 - Communication, but no hype
- Ownership
 - Make the users active stakeholders
 - More likely to forgive or accept problems
 - Can make a big difference to acceptance and success of product

Degrees of user involvement

- Member of the design team
 - Full time: constant input, but lose touch with other users
 - Part time: patchy input, and very stressful
 - Short term: inconsistent across project life
 - Long term: consistent, but lose touch with other users
- Newsletters and other dissemination devices
 - Reach wider selection of users
 - Need communication both ways
- User involvement after product is released
- Combination of these approaches

What is a user-centered approach?

User-centered approach is based on:

- Early focus on users and tasks: directly studying cognitive, behavioral, anthropomorphic & attitudinal characteristics
- Empirical measurement: Early in development, users' reactions and performance to scenarios, manuals, simulations & prototypes are observed, recorded and analysed. Later on, users interact with simulations and prototypes and their performance and reactions are observed, recorded and analyzed.
- Iterative design: when problems are found in user testing, fix them and carry out more tests